

your dad use the computer, and you do not want to create a separate user called “Dad.” You can create a separate partition, and also build a directory structure such as ‘Documents’ for text and office-based files, ‘Pictures’ for images, ‘Songs’ for music files, and so on.

You can also maintain a separate partition to store your song and video collection. The idea behind creating and maintaining separate partitions for your personal and important data is to safeguard them from the consequences of an OS crash.

Many people use Outlook Express or Microsoft Outlook as their e-mail client. The mails thus received are stored somewhere on the C: drive by default; use the account setting options in Outlook (or Outlook Express) to change the ‘Personal Folders’ path to somewhere other than the C: drive. Suppose you change the ‘Personal Folders’ path from ‘C:\Outlook\Personal Folders’ to ‘E:\My Mails\’. A few months down the line, if your system crashes and you reinstall Windows, you can simply reset Outlook’s mail folder path to ‘E:\My Mail’, and you’ll see all your mails intact.

4.3 Searching For Files, Folders, And Documents

It is very easy to search for files and folders in Windows XP—you get a host of options that you can specify, thus speeding up your search.

Press [Windows] + [F] to open the search window. Alternatively, you can open it by clicking Start > Search. Look to the left hand side: you will notice that the Companion offers to filter your search by choosing one of several options:

- Pictures, music or videos
- All files and folders
- Documents (formatted text, spreadsheets, etc.)
- Computers or people

An option to search the Internet is also provided; this uses the MSN search site. The last option you have on the main screen is that